

F5 Daily Briefing - Thursday, August 13, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

16

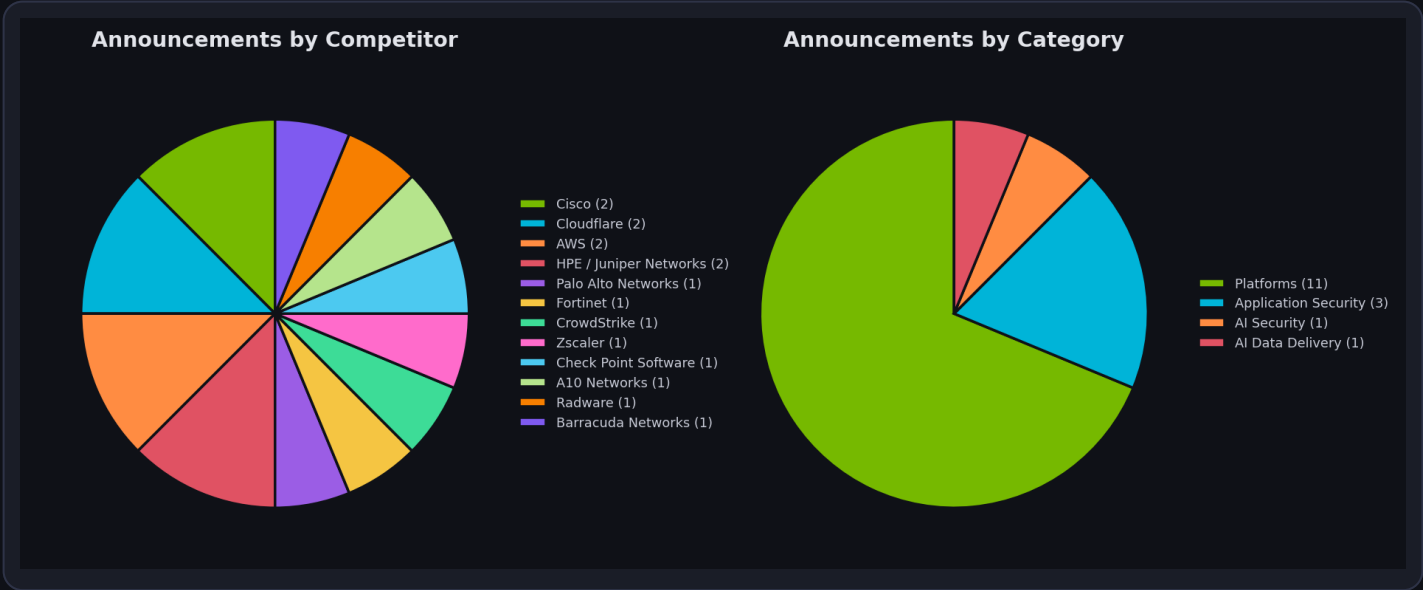
ANNOUNCEMENTS

12

ACTIVE

4

ACTIVE CATEGORIES



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (16)

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Palo Alto Networks

2026-08-13

Palo Alto Networks Deploys OpenAI Frontier Cyber Models Inside Enterprise Networks

Palo Alto Networks expanded its Unit 42 Frontier AI Defense program with OpenAI, running frontier cyber models such as GPT-5.6 Daybreak directly inside customer environments. The new Frontier AI Exposure Analysis service discovers exposures, tests exploitability, validates attack paths and prioritizes remediation by combining OpenAI models with Palo Alto telemetry, Unit 42 threat intelligence and offensive security expertise. The move pushes frontier-model capability out of lab testing and into active defender workflows, extending the program first launched in May 2026.

Source: <https://saassentinel.com/2026/08/13/palo-alto-networks-deploys-openai-cyber-models-inside-enterprise-networks/>

SECURITY ADVISORY

Fortinet

2026-08-13

Fortinet Patches Authentication Bypass Flaws in FortiWeb and FortiManager

Fortinet released patches for eight vulnerabilities across FortiWeb, FortiManager, FortiClient for Windows, FortiOS and FortiSIEM. The headline FortiWeb flaw (CVE-2026-26035) lets an unauthenticated remote attacker log in with arbitrary credentials when a wildcard admin setting is enabled; fixes ship in FortiWeb 8.0.3, 7.6.7, 7.4.12 and 7.2.13. FortiManager's CVE-2026-70468 permits authentication bypass and impersonation of managed FortiGate devices, while FortiClient CVE-2026-70465 enables code execution via crafted DNS responses. Fortinet reports no known in-the-wild exploitation.

Source: <https://www.securityweek.com/fortinet-patches-authentication-flaws-in-fortiweb-and-fortimanager/>

FINANCIAL

Cisco

2026-08-13

Cisco Rides "Networking Supercycle" to Record Q4 and FY2026 Results

Cisco reported Q4 FY2026 revenue of \$17.3B, up 18% year over year, with product revenue up 24% and networking product orders up 40%. Full-year revenue reached \$63.3B, up 12%, and fiscal 2027 guidance of \$72.2B-\$73.4B came in well above consensus. Management credited a networking supercycle driven by AI infrastructure demand, citing roughly \$400M in AI infrastructure orders from neocloud and sovereign customers in Q4 and about \$9.3B in hyperscaler AI orders for the year, with \$7.5B projected for FY2027.

Source: <https://www.networkworld.com/article/4208814/cisco-rides-networking-supercycle-for-strong-q4.html>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Cisco**

2026-08-13

Cisco Fixes Actively Exploited Firewall DoS Vulnerability (CVE-2026-20349)

Cisco issued an advisory for CVE-2026-20349, a high-severity flaw being actively exploited to temporarily disrupt Cisco ASA and Firepower Threat Defense firewalls. CISA added it to the Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog with an August 14, 2026 remediation deadline for US civilian federal agencies. Cisco PSIRT began investigating after observing exploitation and released hot fixes for ASA 9.16 through 9.24 and FTD 7.0 through 10.0. No workarounds or specific indicators of compromise are available, making prompt patching the only mitigation.

Source: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/08/13/cve-2026-20349-cisco-firewalls-dos/>

ANNOUNCEMENT**CrowdStrike**

2026-08-13

CrowdStrike Extends Project QuiltWorks Frontier AI Risk Protection to SMBs

CrowdStrike extended Project QuiltWorks, previously aimed at large enterprises, to small and mid-sized businesses worldwide through distributors, cloud marketplaces and partner networks. Arrow Electronics, Ignition Technology, Nord Security, Pax8, TD SYNnex, Westcon-Comstor and Zip Security will deliver the program's AI-driven vulnerability discovery, prioritization, remediation services and cyber insurance protections on the Falcon platform. CrowdStrike frames the move as making enterprise-grade frontier AI risk protection accessible to organizations of every size as AI-accelerated exploitation compresses patching timelines.

Source: <https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/press-releases/crowdstrike-expands-project-quiltworks-smb-frontier-ai-risk-protection/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Zscaler**

2026-08-13

Zscaler Introduces Zero Trust Gateway for Google Cloud

Zscaler launched Zero Trust Gateway for Google Cloud, a fully managed, auto-scaling security gateway integrated with Google Cloud Network Security Integration. Traffic is steered transparently to Zscaler using Google Cloud Security Profiles, with no application changes, manual tunnels or routing rework. The service delivers high-performance SSL/TLS inspection, advanced threat and ransomware protection, inline DLP and cloud sandboxing, with context-aware policy driven by Google Cloud resource labels and network tags. Zscaler manages deployment and capacity, giving customers single-pane visibility across GCP, other clouds and on-premises workloads.

Source: <https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/product-insights/introducing-zscaler-zero-trust-gateway-google-cloud>

RESEARCH**Check Point Software**

2026-08-13

Check Point Research Publishes The State of Ransomware Q2 2026

Check Point Research found a record 93 active ransomware groups in Q2 2026, while the top 10 accounted for 57.6% of victims, down from 71% in Q1. The quarter saw 2,139 data-leak victims, flat sequentially but up 33% year over year, with Qilin (279) and The Gentlemen (269) leading. Ransom payment rates fell to multi-year lows near 23%. Researchers highlighted AI-assisted tooling development by ransomware operators, narrowing exploitation windows, and shifting victim geography as the US share dropped from 50% to 42%.

Source: <https://research.checkpoint.com/2026/the-state-of-ransomware-q2-2026/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cloudflare**

2026-08-13

Certificate Transparency Monitoring Is Now Generally Available

Cloudflare announced general availability of Certificate Transparency Monitoring, letting customers track and analyze certificate issuance for their domains at scale. The release brings enterprise-ready visibility into SSL/TLS certificates logged in public CT logs, helping teams detect unauthorized or unexpected certificates before they are abused. Cloudflare also noted it will stop sending certificate issuance alerts by email; notifications now surface in the dashboard notification inbox instead.

Source: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/certificate-transparency-monitoring-ga/>

RESEARCH**Cloudflare**

2026-08-13

Total Eclipse of the Internet: Traffic Impacts in Iceland, Spain and Portugal

Using Cloudflare Radar data, Cloudflare analyzed how the August 12 total solar eclipse reshaped European Internet traffic. HTTP request volumes fell roughly 15-30% under the path of totality, with Iceland, Spain and Portugal showing the sharpest declines and some regional drops reaching 46%. Countries with only shallow partial coverage, such as Denmark and Poland, saw minimal change, while Norway and Sweden recorded slight increases. Traffic dips aligned closely with maximum obscuration, confirming the eclipse rather than network faults drove the shift.

Source: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/total-eclipse-internet-traffic-iceland-spain-portugal/>

PARTNERSHIP**AWS**

2026-08-13

Oracle and AWS Deepen Collaboration as Oracle AI Database@AWS Adoption Accelerates

Oracle and AWS expanded their strategic collaboration around Oracle AI Database@AWS, announcing general availability of Oracle Exadata Database Service on Exascale Infrastructure with pay-per-use economics. The service is now available in 22 AWS Regions and adds Oracle Autonomous AI Database Serverless, application-to-database latency as low as 165 microseconds, and Platinum Maximum Availability Architecture support. Integrations span Amazon Bedrock, SageMaker, QuickSight, zero-ETL to Redshift, S3 backups, CloudWatch monitoring and EventBridge, aiming to accelerate lower-risk migration of Oracle workloads onto AWS.

Source: <https://press.aboutamazon.com/aws/2026/8/oracle-and-aws-deepen-strategic-collaboration-as-enterprise-adoption-of-oracle-ai-database-aws-accelerates>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**AWS**

2026-08-13

AWS Spot Placement Score Now Includes Local Zones

AWS announced that Spot Placement Score now factors AWS Local Zones into zonal and regional scores, extending Spot capacity visibility beyond Regions and Availability Zones. Customers can optionally include Local Zone data in score responses to identify where Spot capacity requests are most likely to succeed, improving placement decisions for interruption-tolerant workloads running closer to end users. The capability is accessible through the EC2 Spot console, AWS CLI and SDKs.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/08/spot-placement-score-local-zones/>

ACQUISITION**HPE / Juniper Networks**

2026-08-13

Judge Finalizes HPE's \$14B Juniper Networks Acquisition, Clearing Last Legal Hurdle

A federal judge approved the amended HPE-DOJ settlement, making HPE's \$14 billion acquisition of Juniper Networks legally final despite objections from state attorneys general. HPE said the settlement serves the public interest and highlighted innovations from the combined organization. Since closing, HPE has integrated Juniper technology across its portfolio, shipping HPE Juniper Networking QFX data center switches, folding Juniper switches into Mist AI operations, and launching a unified AI-native SASE platform.

Source: <https://www.networkworld.com/article/4209343/its-final-judge-says-hpes-juniper-acquisition-is-complete.html>

FINANCIAL**HPE / Juniper Networks**

2026-08-13

Juniper Deal Lifts HPE Networking Revenue 148% as Morgan Stanley Upgrades Stock

Analyst coverage highlighted that HPE's Juniper acquisition is shifting the company from low-margin servers toward higher-margin networking, with fiscal Q2 2026 networking revenue up 148.2% to \$2.7 billion post-integration. Morgan Stanley's Erik Woodring argued nearly half of HPE's business is now networking — Mist AI, Marvis and Aruba Central — justifying a higher valuation multiple than a server-centric view, and upgraded HPE to Overweight citing accelerating competitive benefits from the integration.

Source: <https://www.techtimes.com/articles/324307/20260813/lenovo-doubles-infrastructure-revenue-lifting-hpe-8-juniper-makes-it-more-ai-server-rally.htm>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**A10 Networks**

2026-08-13

A10 Networks Launches A10 AI Gateway, an Intelligent Control Plane for AI Operations

A10 Networks announced general availability of the A10 AI Gateway, unveiled at Black Hat USA 2026. It acts as a centralized control plane unifying intelligent request routing, real-time per-request cost tracking, per-model and per-team token budgets, governance and observability across AI agents, applications and LLMs. Delivered as software or integrated hardware, it runs entirely in the customer's environment — on-premises, private cloud or air-gapped — for data sovereignty, and complements TrojAI by A10 Networks and ThreatX in A10's AI security lineup.

Source: <https://www.a10networks.com/news/press-releases/a10-networks-launches-a10-ai-gateway-an-intelligent-control-plane-for-all-ai-operations/>

AWARD**Radware**

2026-08-13

Radware Positioned as a Leader in QKS Group SPARK Matrix: API Security, 2026

Radware was named a Leader in the QKS Group SPARK Matrix for API Security, 2026. QKS credited Radware's unified platform for combining continuous API discovery from live traffic, contextual testing, runtime posture management and real-time mitigation in a single system. Analysts highlighted strength in blocking business-logic abuse and API-layer DDoS in production, plus behavioral analytics, ML-based anomaly detection, schema enforcement and OWASP API Top 10 coverage. Radware said the recognition validates its end-to-end approach for enterprises running complex hybrid, multi-cloud application environments.

Source: <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/radware-positioned-as-a-leader-in-the-spark-matrix-api-security-2026-by-qks-group-302851267.html>

RESEARCH

Barracuda Networks

2026-08-13

Barracuda Research: AI Supercharges BEC Attacks via Microsoft Copilot

Barracuda Networks detailed red-team research showing how attackers weaponize Microsoft 365 Copilot after an account compromise. Using only natural-language queries, the simulated attacker mapped org structure, tone and financial threads, then crafted a convincing wire-transfer request within minutes — producing a simulated \$265,000 loss with no advanced hacking. Barracuda's Merium Khalid warned that AI compresses the window from infiltration to loss and raises insider-threat risk, urging rigorous patching, firewall audits and device monitoring, noting unmonitored rogue devices featured in every ransomware case analyzed.

Source: <https://www.darkreading.com/threat-intelligence/how-ai-is-amplifying-insider-threats-and-risks-with-merium-khalid>